

THE PLATES OF DANA

DANA AND SHANNON GORBAHN FAMILY — CHRISTMAS & HISTORY LETTER — 2023



Hey Everyone,

"May this Christmas wrap you in the warmth of family, fill your home with laughter, and sprinkle joy into every moment. Wishing our cherished family and friends a season of love, peace, and unforgettable moments. Merry Christmas!" These Christmas Letters have been our little history and so we are now calling them the "Plates of Dana".

Jadyn: Hey everybody! It feels like this year flew right by and I don't even know what really happened. At the beginning of the year I moved out of the house right across from my parents and into a studio apartment in the old gone hollywood building. Back when I was 8 and we first renovated the place and I saw this apartment and I said "I'm gonna live here one day" and here I am. It's absolutely perfect, I'm living the downtown life being right on mainstreet, I love it. I've mostly just been working away at Gpar but over the summer I got to runaway a few times! First I drove to Calgary to see Kai, Kaleb and Lauren. It was such a nice visit. Then I got to fly out to Victoria to stay with my good friend Megan and also saw Taaron while I was there. Megan and I had so much fun together. There was one day that we decided to go for a little drive out to Sooke but then we ended up in Shirley then Jordan River then landed in Port Renfrew. We asked a local about a beach to go to and we found it and it was such a beautiful moment being on that beach and watching the waves. I hadn't been near the ocean in so many years. I'll cherish that trip for the rest of my life. I also went back to Calgary for a kids thanksgiving which was so special! Lauren and I did the turkey together, I felt like an actual adult. it was weird. My



favourite part about that trip was realizing that I love playing Uno and I mean LOVE. I think the biggest news of this year would be that I'm going to be an auntie!!! And because of that, my parents and I will be moving to Calgary!!! As excited as I am, it's going to feel so different moving away this time considering my parents won't still be here in Smithers. The next few months here will be my final months of my Smithers life and it's crazy to think about! But we're all looking so forward to this new adventure! I hope everyone had a great year and I hope this next year treats all you good. Merry Christmas, love you all!

Kaleb: 2023 was a whirlwind of a year! We started off in Arizona where I continued to chase his dreams as a professional golfer, and Lauren continued working remotely for TRADER Corp. From there, we made our way round Canada and the Western side of the US, playing tournaments the whole way. We were



blessed to have my Dad join us in California where he caddied for Kaleb at the PGA Tour Canada Qualifying School. Not long after, we made our way over to Ontario to visit Lauren's family and compete in the Canadian Open Qualifier. The visit was an extra special one, as we discovered that we were pregnant with our baby girl, due in February 2024. We were far too excited to keep it a secret and told Lauren's family the next morning and traveled to share the news with my family within the next couple weeks. After that, our lives really started changing as we got ready for our baby. We knew we couldn't keep living as nomads, hopping from city to city, and quickly started hunting for a place to settle down. We bought a house in Calgary and got to work making it our home. I landed a job coaching golf at the Lynx Ridge Golf Club and have really been enjoying teaching. To end off the summer, we made our way to Italy for the European Tour Qualifying School. While we were there, we visited the

Colosseum, Lauren (still being in her first trimester) threw up at the Vatican City, we saw the beautiful Italian countryside, and ate sooo much pasta! Now we're back in Alberta, getting ready for the Christmas season, enjoying our new home, and treasuring every little kick from our precious baby girl. As we enter this new chapter in our lives, we're so thankful for all the love and support we've received from family and friends. We feel very loved and blessed to be surrounded by so many amazing people. From our little family to yours, we wish you the merriest of Christmases and countless blessings for the new year. Lots of love, Lauren and Kaleb.



Taaron: Hello all! What an amazing, super fun, fantastic 2023 it has been! Work as always has been excellent - it's been such a pleasure to be part of such a wonderful team building cutting edge technology. I've been with the company for more than five years now and it's been such a rewarding journey and experience. Here's to many more years! I had some amazing

opportunities to visit family this year! In the spring, my mom came down to Victoria and helped me paint my apartment. In the summer, Jadyne came to visit for a few days and in the fall, all the kids met up in Calgary for Thanksgiving. I'm so blessed to have such a loving family, it's always a joy to see each other. This year was also my big trip for finally beating my dad at golf! We went on an unforgettable cruise together from LA to Mexico. I wasn't able to secure a second win but the times we had together will



never be forgotten! We chartered a fishing boat in Cabo and after a half hour fight, I caught a massive Blue Marlin! I've also picked up on some of my old passions again. In particular, I've been seeing plays, attending comedy shows and have been taking improv classes with a plan to do some local performances here in Victoria! It's been an absolute

blast! Here's to another fantastic year! I hope 2023 was as special for you as it was for me! Talk to you again in 2024!



Kai: Hello my family and friends, another year has passed. I've been in Calgary for five years - and it's still my favorite city! I'm so grateful for all the memories I've made here, and look forward to all the many more memories to come. It's been so exciting to have Kaleb and Lauren decide to live here too. It came as quite the surprise, but was definitely meant to be. I always had a feeling that the family would be drawn here, just like I was. It's a real blessing to have family close by, and such a special gift that Kaleb and Lauren are bringing a new member of the family into our lives. I'm still working as a server at Milestones, which has been the most wonderful job. The restaurant is located in a mall, which makes it very busy this time of year! We have a great team and I couldn't be more thankful. These days I focus a lot on personal health, always aiming



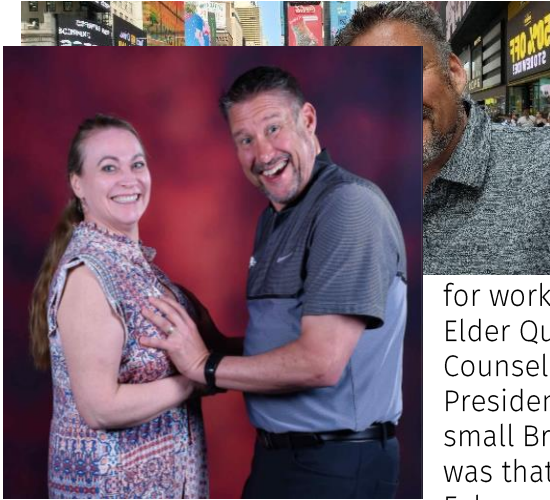
to improve the quality of my life as much as I can. This year I've really dived into the art of cooking, something I always wanted to be passionate about. I love the aromas and all the time and energy it takes! Also, what a joy it is to prepare dinner for someone else - that's an added bonus to the experience. I wish you all a Merry Christmas. All my love, Kai.



Shannon: It has been a wonderful year. A few changes coming up with our anticipated move to Calgary. I am very excited to be closer to 2 of my boys and have my Jaddy there as well. So thankful for such a wonderful daughter in law that wants us close by too. Grama GG a will be able to help with the arrival of our granddaughter. I continue to teach yoga at my

studio and have begun working for the Salvation Army. It started as just volunteering and quickly moved to part time. I have really enjoyed being there. It is mostly helping in the soup kitchen. Serving meals and cooking. Wishing you all a very merry Christmas and a Happy New Year. Love Shannon.





Dana: It's been another wonderful year for me and my family. I again, get to enjoy life in so many ways. Work has had its challenges with the difficulties of recruiting staff and needing to start all over with new and young managers; however, we got through it and are better for it. I still serve on Local/Provincial Boards, Committees, and Advisory Panels

for work. I also serve as the Elder Quorum President and 1 Counsellor in the Branch Presidency in our very very small Branch. Our biggest news was that Lauren is expecting in February 2024 and with that –

Shannon firmly declared that we were going to move to the Calgary area to be close to our new granddaughter. With this upcoming move, we have started to work on liquidating many of the things we have here in Smithers. We have a sale for our commercial Gone Hollywood Video building. I have two organizations wanting to purchase my GPAR business with those properties included, except the commercial office/yoga studio building. So things are coming along. We actually have someone wanting to buy our home when we are ready to sell. We did try to sell one of our condos but



no buyers, and we don't want to keep it vacant, so it is rented again. There are so many loose ends but it will all work out. I continue to officiate basketball and am the local association trainer. I also got selected to do Provincials and had a great time there. I was assigned some very key games and enjoyed the excitement and challenge. On Valentine's Day (Feb 14th) our Family Feud show appeared on TV. We had a viewing party at our place and friends and family joined us on Zoom for the experience. We are still haunted by not giving answers that we thought wouldn't be on the board – and I kept giving



“booze” as an answer. Kaleb asked me to join them in California to caddy for him in the PGA Tour Canada Qualifying Tournament. It was great to do that again with him and to be with both him and Lauren for a week. It was at that time that I developed tinnitus. Wow, it kind of changed my life and early on, I really couldn't emotional handle it. I was on the verge of a real emotional meltdown. Shortly after that trip to caddy, Shannon and I went to NYC (e-scooter in Central Park, Gutfield Show, Tribute Queen



Concert); and then a cruise to the Caribbean. After the cruise we headed to our special place in Arizona. We met Marinda and John there and had some wonderful time visiting with them. Our next trip was to our Family Reunion. So great to see my brothers and sisters, nieces and nephews (and their kids) – and most of all to see my mom (my little angel). After the reunion, Shannon and I (with our Oliver) spend some time in Whistler. That was such a relaxing and enjoyable time. Following that - I took them home and then headed back down south for the BC Senior Golf Championships. I played so well but on the last day, my nerves got to me (on the half wedge shots) and at one point I literally couldn't even swing the club. It was crazy. I should have gotten a penalty stroke for slow play but they let me get through it. Our long-time cat – Frost had deteriorated in health so much because of age that she couldn't even



step into the cat litter. It was so sad to have to put her down but what made it bearable, was that she really needed it to happen. Her quality of life had become so poor. We will miss that beautiful looking pet. Kaleb again, asked me to caddy for him in the Vancouver Open - and again, that was a pleasure to be a part of it. The last day was so great. I hadn't seen Kaleb enjoy a round more than that for a very long time. He would hit booming drives and then walk over to the side and hold hands with his wife Lauren; and then meet me at his ball. People were

buzzing all over the course about how long this guy was hitting and they wanted to see it themselves. People were thanking Kaleb for being able to see that. It was nice to see him enjoy the day! Later in the fall, Shannon and I went to Arizona again to get the house ready for the rental season. We worked hard at getting it ready. Our friends Richard and Tanya Norton joined us for a few days. It was great to rekindle that friendship. When Shannon headed home, I met Taaron in Los Angeles for a 5-night cruise. Taaron had beaten me last year in golf and got to chose a golf vacation of his choice and this was it. We went deep sea fishing for marlin in Cabo San Lucas; and T caught one - a 140 pounder. It was so great. T worked hard at getting it in. Bruised and blistered but it was in the boat. The next stop was a great day of golfing at Bajamar Golf Course. Such a great round in some of the windiest conditions that I've ever seen. Once we arrived back in LA, we stayed at a resort and played their two courses. Both beautiful, but one of them may be my favourite one in all of California that I've played (except Pebble Beach). And then getting home, I am trying to get as much steelhead fishing as I can since it might not happen as much once we move to Calgary. Again, what a blessed and fulfilling year and we are excited to see what next year brings us!



Gorbahn Challenge: I'm sorry to say that this challenge has not materialized for a few years. Again, Luke was unable to come to Smithers to fish but I did kick his butt in golf at our little Family Reunion. I'll say it's another win for me and I don't think I'll have much argument.

We love you all and wish the very best for you, always! *With all our Love - Dana, Shannon, Kai, Taaron, Kaleb, Lauren, Jaddy, Louie, Oliver, and Kali!*

